



Computer Literacy Program 2021 Annual Report

It is a pleasure to report to you the persistent and transformative activities of the Computer Literacy Program (CLP), even though the variations of COVID-19 virus still rage on. The seventeenth year of CLP operation continued within the pandemic with considerable success in different areas. What follows is a brief account of the key CLP activities, initiatives and accomplishments.

- ❖ Eleven new Computer Literacy Centers (CLCs), including 8 “Tokai” (not supported by the original sponsors) centers were established bringing the total to 289. One of these new CLCs started with 8 computers.
- ❖ With the establishment of 9 more Smart Class Rooms (SCRs) the total now stands at 182. Three of these SCRS are also equipped with remote conferencing capabilities.
- ❖ Even during the COVID shutdown, major hardware replacement and upgrades were carried out in 11 centers, and Dnet personnel visited 49 centers between January and December.
- ❖ Remote Voluntary Teaching (RVT) gained momentum during the pandemic, drawing volunteer teachers of different age groups (high school students, recent graduates, retired professionals and a senior college professor) from home and abroad. CLP established collaboration with Fera Foundation, Inc. (FF), a not-for-profit organization based in New York City, which provided the remote teaching services of several volunteer teachers. With ample volunteer teachers on board, RVT enabled an orphanage in Gazipur conduct over 30 classes covering different subjects within its own premises, thus making the underprivileged students among the most privileged in classroom access. Learn more about RVT in a comprehensive article in the 2021 CLP [magazine](#).
- ❖ CLP volunteer program is attracting many Bangladeshi American youth volunteers and their peers (not necessarily of Bangladeshi origin), who are actively engaged in various CLP programs and breaking new grounds. CLP recognized Nashwaan Ali Khan, a star volunteer from a Whitney High School (Cerritos, CA) with the 2021 United States “President Volunteer Service Award” Gold Medal for his grit, initiative, leadership and dedicated teaching. Please read Nashwaan’s story in the 2021 CLP magazine linked above.
- ❖ CLP and Dnet organized several meetings and training sessions throughout the year.

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- *First*, the CLP-Dnet-FF team hosted a highly appreciated online primary school teachers training session by an experienced teacher trainer from the New York City Education system focusing on Student Engagement Strategies.
 - *Second*, a virtual training session for CLP school teachers brought 107 teachers from 77 CLP-affiliated schools who received training from Dnet professionals on how to teach classes using social media that students can connect to using cell phones. The trained teachers later used the tool to connect with and teach students.
 - *Third*, Dnet organized another virtual conference between teachers and sponsors of CLCs and SCRs. The event seemed to energize the teachers as it was a welcome relief from their isolation. The sponsors appreciated meeting with the teachers and learning how their sponsored centers had been operating.
- ❖ Several new programs were initiated.
- *First*, a program to introduce CLP digital curriculum to non-CLP schools with ample computers but no structured training programs was launched. CLP student volunteers are running a campaign to raise funds for this initiative.
 - *Second*, a ‘*Tokai Center Sponsorship Program*’ to resurrect the centers that are currently not supported by the original sponsors has been designed. A new sponsor can adopt a Tokai center for a much-reduced cost than what is required to establish a new center, and be recognized for the generosity. Please find more about this program at
 - *Third*, a program to maintain contact and network with CLP alumni has been planned in collaboration with Technuf, LLC, an information technology based small business established by expatriate Bangladeshis.
- ❖ CLP’s 2021 Annual event was held on October 15 virtually with a global audience. The exciting, informative and entertaining program attracted record number of viewers. In case you were unable to attend the live event, you may enjoy the recoded [video](#).

CLP needs your continued support

CLP sincerely appreciates your support and donations to continue its activities. We recognize that the current crisis surrounding COVID-19 has left its unprecedented financial impact on many of us. CLP, too, is feeling the impact in its donation collection for last two years. However, the need to help the less fortunate has become more urgent and more critical than ever. Your sustained support and generous contributions are crucial to the overall success of the program. Please send your tax-deductible donations to **CLP** and mail to **6 Tharp Lane, Marlboro, NJ 07746**, if you have not already done so.

Please enable Amazon to donate 0.5% of your Amazon online shopping to CLP by using Amazon Smile browser and selecting CLP your favorite charity.

CLP wishes you, your family and friends a safe, happy, healthy and prosperous New Year 2022.

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